Status Report #1

Oct 13, 2026 · @Noa

RealEye now works end to end with a placeholder model: the Chrome extension reads a webpage, sends its text to our server, and shows the result in the popup.

Project overview

- **Project:** RealEye, a Chrome extension that helps users spot potentially AI-generated text and images.
- **Team:** Charlize, Tara, Anastasia, Anastasia, Noa (CMSI 4071).
- **Reporting period:** start of coding through October 13, 2026.
- **Repository:** the team GitHub repo; all work below is merged into `main`.

Progress

We finished the first three of our eight build stages. The full scan path works, but the server returns a fixed placeholder result (50% model estimate) until the real models are trained.

Stage	What we did	Status
0. Repository setup	Created three folders: `extension/` (Chrome Manifest V3, React 18 + TypeScript), `server/` (Python 3.11 + FastAPI), `ml/` (PyTorch + Hugging Face)	Done
1. API contract	Wrote `docs/api-contract.md`, the agreed message format between the extension and the server	Done
2. End-to-end skeleton	Extension sends page text to the server and displays the results; server returns a placeholder answer in the real format	Done, tested October 13
Documentation	`README.md` with Windows and Mac setup steps; `docs/progress.md` with stages, decisions, and known limitations	Done

Next steps

Next we split into three parallel tracks (Stage 3); we will assign owners at our next team meeting.

Track	Planned work
A. Extension and page	Image scanning, scans over 10 items, progress and cancel, inline warning labels on the page, help view
B. Server	Input limits (text length and language, image size and format), HTTP 403/413/429 errors, the warning rule as a tested function, C2PA check
C. Machine learning	Collect and license datasets, split into training/validation/test sets, fine-tune text and image models, pick thresholds on validation data, target F1 of at least 0.75 and a false-positive rate of at most 10%

After the tracks, the remaining stages are:

1. Stage 4: replace the placeholder with the trained models.
2. Stage 5: shareable report links that expire after 7 days.
3. Stage 6: testing for accessibility, keyboard use, the SRS timing targets, and held-out model accuracy.
4. Stage 7: host the server on HTTPS and package the extension.

Troubleshooting and open questions

Open questions

- **SynthID access:** Google may not offer a detector API we are allowed to use. For now the server reports SynthID as "unavailable", which the SRS allows.
- **Training data:** we still need to choose the text and image datasets and confirm their licenses allow our use. The SRS requires recording each dataset's source and permitted use.
- **Track owners:** not yet assigned for Stage 3.